Outdoor digital advertising

Building-mounted LED versus private-land unipole — cost estimate, rent, regulatory cash, and SWOT for a first Kochi site (Edappally / Kakkanad class sightline).

PATH A — BUILDING

Rent a commercial terrace or façade. Same 32 sq.m P3.91 screen. No pole, no piles, sub-meter on the building.

PATH B — UNIPOLE

12–15 m pole on private land outside NH RoW. Own foundation, own KSEB, own earth and lightning.

RECOMMENDED FIRST ASSET

One 8 m × 4 m (32 sq.m) road-facing P3.91 / P4 face, volume OEM, IP65, ≥ 5,500 nits — on a building if a sightline exists.

DATE

07 September 2026 · Kochi · Kozhikode · Kannur

PATH A — BUILDING, CASH LIVE **₹38–45 lakh**	PATH B — UNIPOLE 1-FACE, CASH LIVE **₹55–62 lakh**
PATH B — UNIPOLE DUAL, CASH LIVE **₹75–90 lakh**	PREMIUM DUAL UNIPOLE (USD 650 FOB) **~₹90–93 lakh**

Advertisement tax, stamp duty, KSEB tariff and customs BCD must be confirmed against the live gazette and the Corporation schedule before capital is committed. This is not a legal opinion or a quotation from an OEM. Do not order FOB LED until owner / land NOC and a Corporation file number exist.

1. How the cost is split

READ THIS FIRST

Two outdoor paths, one Kochi site. Mall kiosks are a different product and are not costed here. Do not start with two outdoor boards. If a commercial terrace or façade has a real road sightline, use Path A. Use Path B only if there is no such building, or you need both carriageways on one plot.

Same 32 sq.m P3.91 screen. Different civil, power and rent. Volume OEM (USD 330 / sq.m FOB), first site only — do not load a 6-node spare kit onto the first pole.

Item	Path A — building 1-face	Path B — unipole 1-face	Path B — unipole dual
What it is	LED on rented terrace / façade	12–15 m pole, 1 screen, private land	Same pole, 2 screens, both carriageways
LED area	32 sq.m	32 sq.m	64 sq.m
Structure	Rooftop MS frame + strengthening ₹6.5 L	Pole + piles + soil + PE ₹17.8 L	Heavier pole + dual frames ₹20.5 L
Power	Building LT-VII(A) sub-meter	Own KSEB 15 kW	Own KSEB 25 kW
Hardware economic	**₹29 L**	**₹46 L**	**₹64 L**
Hardware cash (incl. IGST)	**₹31 L**	**₹48 L**	**₹68 L**
Year-0 admin / tax / engineers	₹5–8 L	₹6–10 L	₹6–10 L
Space deposit (3–6 months)	₹1.5–6.0 L	₹2.4–4.8 L	₹2.4–4.8 L
Cash to be live (plan)	**₹38–45 L**	**₹55–62 L**	**₹75–90 L**
Rent floor (hybrid 18%)	₹50,000 or 18% of ads	₹80,000 or 18% of ads	₹80,000 or 18% of ads
Power / month (ex-rent)	₹50–60k (20% building markup)	~₹48,500 (own KSEB)	~₹96,000
Typical permit path	3–5 months	4–6 months + monsoon civil window	4–6 months + monsoon civil window
When to choose	Commercial terrace with road sightline	No building; one carriageway is enough	No building; need both carriageways

Premium listed OEM (USD 650 / sq.m) on a dual unipole is the ~₹90–93 L hardware cash figure often quoted for a “land pole”. Volume OEM dual is ~₹68 L cash hardware — still about 2× a building-mounted single face. All ₹ at ₹84 / USD. IGST at Cochin Port is claimed as ITC.

2. Path A — building-mounted hardware

All figures are economic CAPEX (IGST excluded from the total, shown separately as cash). USD/INR 84. Customs on CTH 8528 52 00: BCD 10% + AIDC + SWS ≈ 12.1% of CIF. Conservative reclass to 8528 59 00 (20% BCD) would add roughly ₹1.0–1.3 L on a single 32 sq.m face.

Cost bucket	Compact 6×3 m 18 sq.m, 1 face	Recommended 8×4 m 32 sq.m, 1 face	Dual-face rooftop 2 × 32 sq.m
A. Digital screen (LED FOB + freight + BCD/AIDC/SWS)	₹6.9 L	₹11.6 L	₹22.6 L
B. Structure on the building (steel, anchors, walkway, waterproofing)	₹4.5 L	₹6.5 L	₹9.5 L
C. Setup (electrical, SPD, earth, sub-meter, NovaStar, install, licence pack, spares, 8% buffer)	₹8.3 L	₹10.9 L	₹15.7 L
Economic total	**₹20 L**	**₹29 L**	**₹48 L**
IGST at port (GST credit)	₹1.2 L	₹2.1 L	₹4.1 L
Cash to switch the screen on	**₹21 L**	**₹31 L**	**₹52 L**

Premium cabinets (Unilumin / Absen class, ~USD 650 / sq.m) add about **₹10 lakh** on the 32 sq.m single face (economic ~₹39 L, cash ~₹43 L). Not required for site one if factory FAT (IP65, 5,500 nits, salt spray, 72-hour burn-in) is passed.

Dual-face is worth the extra LED bill only if *both* directions have paying traffic. Otherwise buy one road-facing face.

2.1 Recommended 32 sq.m, one face — line by line

Split	Item	₹
Screen	LED cabinets FOB (32 sq.m × USD 330 × 84)	8,87,000
Screen	Sea freight + insurance to ICTT Vallarpadam	1,50,000
Screen	Customs BCD + AIDC + SWS	1,25,000
Structure	Terrace / facade steel frame, chemical anchors, walkway, waterproofing make-good	6,50,000
Setup	LT panel, Class II SPD, ELCB, earthing ≤ 2 Ω	1,80,000
Setup	Building sub-meter / commercial power tap	80,000
Setup	NovaStar TB60 + industrial player + dual-SIM 4G	1,65,000
Setup	Structural PE certificate + year-1 advertisement licence pack	1,50,000
Setup	Hoist / crane, install, 72-hour burn-in	1,20,000
Setup	Spare modules + Mean Well PSU	1,80,000
Setup	Contingency 8%	2,15,000
	Economic CAPEX	**29,02,000**
	IGST cash at port (ITC)	2,09,000
	Cash to switch on	**31,11,000**

Rounded to the nearest thousand. Hardware licence pack in this table is the OEM/file bundle; full lawyer + tax cash is in Section 5 so it is not double-counted in the ₹38–45 L live figure.

3. Path B — private-land unipole hardware

Same LED cabinets as Path A. The extra cash is civil and power: a 12–15 m IS 2062 pole, pile or raft foundation, two soil boreholes, own lightning protection, and a *new* KSEB LT-VII(A) service. Spares below are a **first-site kit** (₹1.8 L / face-equivalent), not the 6-node warehouse kit (₹4.2–6.3 L) in the network calculator.

Cost bucket	Unipole 8×4 m 32 sq.m, 1 face	Unipole dual 2 × 32 sq.m
A. Digital screen (LED FOB + freight + BCD/AIDC/SWS)	₹11.6 L	₹22.6 L
B. Pole, foundation, soil, PE	₹17.8 L	₹20.5 L
C. Setup (earth, lightning, own KSEB, NovaStar, install, statutory pack, first-site spares, 8% buffer)	₹16.1 L	₹21.0 L
Economic total	**₹46 L**	**₹64 L**
IGST at port (GST credit)	₹2.1 L	₹4.1 L
Cash to switch the screen on	**₹48 L**	**₹68 L**

Premium cabinets (~USD 650 / sq.m) on the **dual** unipole take hardware cash to about **₹90–93 L** — that is the "₹90 lakh land pole" figure. On a single-face volume OEM pole the premium path is ~₹60 L cash, not ₹90 L. Dual-face is the commercial default on a unipole because one structure covers both carriageways; it is usually wasted on a rooftop.

3.1 Single-face 32 sq.m ground unipole — line by line

Split	Item	₹
Screen	LED cabinets FOB (32 sq.m × USD 330 × 84) — same as Path A	8,87,000
Screen	Sea freight + insurance to ICTT Vallarpadam	1,50,000
Screen	Customs BCD + AIDC + SWS	1,25,000
Structure	12–15 m MS unipole, pile/raft, 2 soil boreholes, coastal C5-M paint, PE	17,80,000
Setup	Electrical, earthing pits ≤ 2 Ω, Class II SPD, lightning IS/IEC 62305	2,80,000
Setup	New KSEB LT-VII(A) 3-phase 15 kW (deposit + service line + meter)	2,20,000
Setup	NovaStar TB60 + industrial player + dual-SIM 4G	1,65,000
Setup	K-SWIFT / municipal / PWD / NHAI first-year statutory pack	2,50,000
Setup	Crane, night lift, weld NDT, 72-hour burn-in	1,80,000
Setup	First-site spare modules + Mean Well PSU (not the 6-node kit)	1,80,000
Setup	Contingency 8%	3,37,000
	Economic CAPEX	**45,55,000**
	IGST cash at port (ITC)	2,09,000
	Cash to switch on	**47,64,000**

Matches the calculator's unipole civil and KSEB lines, with first-site spares instead of the network warehouse kit. Rounded to the nearest thousand.

3.2 Dual-face 32 sq.m ground unipole — what changes

Item vs single-face	₹
Second 32 sq.m face (FOB + freight + duty)	+11.0 L
Heavier pole and dual frames (₹20.47 L vs ₹17.80 L)	+2.7 L
Electrical, KSEB 25 kW, controller, install, extra spares, extra 8%	+4.9 L
Economic total (volume OEM)	**64,08,000**
IGST at port	4,06,000
Cash to switch on (volume OEM)	**68,15,000**
Same dual pole, premium FOB USD 650 / sq.m — cash	~92,45,000

Live cash on top of hardware: add ₹6–10 L year-0 admin (more PWD / NHAI / KMBR than a rooftop) and ₹2.4–4.8 L land deposit (3–6 months of the ₹80,000 Kochi floor). Plan **₹55–62 L** to go live on one face, **₹75–90 L** on dual (the top of that band covers premium cabinets or a highway file that runs long).

4. Renting cost (monthly)

This is the lease for the wall, terrace, or plot — not the screen. Sign a **hybrid**: minimum guarantee or 18% of that board's Gross Advertising Revenue, whichever is higher. Register the licence if the term exceeds 11 months (Kerala Stamp Act + Registration Act).

4.1 Path A — commercial building (terrace / façade)

Location quality	Fixed rent / month	Revenue share alternative	Deposit
Kochi Class A — Edappally, Kakkanad, Vyttila, MG / Banerji sightline	₹70,000–₹1,20,000	15–18% of board ads	3–6 months
Kochi Class B — good road, weaker sightline	₹35,000–₹60,000	12–15%	3 months
Kozhikode — Thondayad / city arterial	₹40,000–₹80,000	15–18%	3–6 months
Kannur — commercial building	₹20,000–₹40,000	12–15%	3 months

Recommended first building contract (Kochi Class A)

Term	Detail
Model	Hybrid: **₹50,000 minimum or 18% of ads**, whichever higher, plus GST
Lock-in	18 months inside a 36-month licence
Deposit	3 months of the minimum (₹1.50 L), interest-free, refundable on make-good
Power	Commercial sub-meter; markup on KSEB energy **capped at 20%**

Term	Detail
Worked rent at 75% sold	Revenue ₹3.75 L × 18% = **₹67,500 / month**
Worked rent if unsold	Floor **₹50,000 / month**

Do not take ₹1.5 lakh fixed rent on a dark screen. If the owner wants equity instead of rent: owner gives space + deposit waived; you put in the ₹31 L hardware; split ads **70/30 or 80/20 in your favour** in year 1.

4.2 Path B — private land under a unipole

Land is dearer than a terrace because the owner is giving a dedicated plot, setbacks, and usually a new service line through their property. The calculator floor for Kochi outdoor land is **₹80,000** (not ₹50,000).

Location quality	Fixed rent / month	Revenue share alternative	Deposit
Kochi outdoor land — Edappally / Kakkanad, outside NH RoW	₹80,000–₹1,50,000	18% of board ads	3–6 months
Kozhikode outdoor land — Thondayad / city arterial	₹45,000–₹80,000	18%	3–6 months

Recommended first land contract (Kochi)

Term	Detail
Model	Hybrid: **₹80,000 minimum or 18% of ads**, whichever higher, plus GST
Lock-in	18 months inside a 36-month licence; make-good of piles is expensive — write the exit
Deposit	3 months of the minimum (₹2.40 L), interest-free, refundable on make-good
Power	Own KSEB LT-VII(A) in your name; do not sit on the landowner’s domestic meter
Worked rent, 1-face, 75% sold	Revenue ₹3.75 L × 18% = ₹67,500 → floor binds at **₹80,000 / month**
Worked rent, dual-face, 75% sold	Revenue ₹7.50 L × 18% = **₹1,35,000 / month**
Worked rent if unsold	Floor **₹80,000 / month** on both 1-face and dual

4.3 Other monthly costs (not rent, still yours)

Item	Building 1-face	Unipole 1-face	Unipole dual
Electricity, 18 h, auto-dim	₹50–60k (20% markup)	~₹48,500 (own KSEB)	~₹96,000
CMS + 4G	₹3,500	₹3,500	₹3,500
Local technician / AMC	₹8,000–₹12,000	₹8,000–₹12,000	₹12,000–₹18,000
Advertisement tax (planning)	~₹13,000 Class A	~₹13,000 Class A	~₹26,000 Class A
Total besides rent	**₹75,000–₹90,000**	**₹73,000–₹78,000**	**₹1.35–1.45 L**

All-in monthly (rent + power + tax + upkeep), Kochi Class A, one face: building **₹1.2–2.0 L**; unipole **₹1.5–2.3 L** (higher floor, slightly cheaper power). Dual unipole at 75% sold: rent ₹1.35 L + ~₹1.4 L other ≈ **₹2.7–2.8 L** against ₹7.50 L gross.

5. Administrative and regulatory cash

Neither path skips ss. 271–272 of the Kerala Municipality Act. Path A skips piles and a roadside pole. Path B is treated as a new outdoor display “building”: soil, KMBR as a new structure, own KSEB service, and tighter setbacks.

5.1 One-time filings and professionals

Item	Typical ₹	Time
Company + GSTIN + current account	20,000–40,000	2 weeks
IEC (only if importing LED)	3,000–10,000	1–2 weeks
Advocate: title check + leave-and-licence	40,000–80,000	2–3 weeks
Stamp + registration of 36-month licence (~5% of average annual rent)	40,000–70,000	1–2 weeks
Structural audit of existing building + LED frame design	75,000–1,50,000	2–4 weeks
IBPMS / KMBR drawings + scrutiny	40,000–1,00,000	30–60 days
Advertisement file, miscellaneous Corporation fees	10,000–25,000	with s. 272
Electrical Inspectorate scheme + inspection	8,000–25,000	15–30 days
KSEB commercial sub-meter / load paperwork	10,000–80,000	15–45 days
AAI NOCAS (if roof enters CIAL surfaces)	15,000–50,000	15–45 days
PWD / Road Safety / NHAI pack (if the face addresses a highway)	15,000–40,000	30–90 days
Year-1 public liability (₹2 Cr) + equipment insurance	20,000–40,000	1 week
Professionals + filings, excluding advertisement tax	**₹3–6 L (use ₹4.5 L)**	
Year-1 advertisement tax — Class A digital 32 sq.m × ₹5,000	**₹1.60 L**	Pay before permission
All-in year-0 regulatory cash	**₹5–8 L building · ₹6–10 L unipole**	**Critical path 8–12 weeks (no NH) or 4–6 months (highway / new pole)**

Tax formula used: area (sq.m) × zone rate × digital factor 2.0. Class A planning rate ₹2,500 static → ₹5,000 digital. Class B → ₹3,000 digital (₹96,000 / year on 32 sq.m). Confirm the live council schedule; the Act does not freeze a statewide rupee rate.

5.2 Gates that still apply on a rented building

Gate	Why it still applies	If skipped
Owner / association NOC	No right to load terrace or facade	Removal; you eat the screen
ss. 271–272 permission + tax	Private buildings are not exempt	Fine, seizure, High Court climate
KMBR / IBPMS	LED frame is an advertising sign / outdoor display	Unauthorised addition
Structural certificate of the building	32 sq.m LED is a wind sail on someone else's slab	Collapse / insurer void
Electrical Inspectorate	Advertising / neon-class installations	No lawful energisation
Commercial meter	12 kW cannot sit on domestic LT	Back-billing, disconnection
PWD / NHAI	If the face sells NH 66 or SH traffic	Hazard notice even on private terrace
AAI NOCAS	Extra height near CIAL	Height cut

Do not order full FOB cabinets until there is a written owner / land NOC and a Corporation file number. Import can beat permission by six weeks; warehouse then costs more than the fee.

5.3 Extra gates on a unipole (Path B only)

Gate	Why it is extra vs a building	If skipped
Soil investigation (2 boreholes)	Piles / raft on laterite and fill; cost sits inside the ₹17.8 L structure line	Under-designed foundation; monsoon tilt
KMBR as a new "building" / outdoor display	A pole is not an addition to an existing occupancy; IBPMS treats it as a new structure	Unauthorised construction, easier demolition
Own KSEB LT-VII(A) service	Cannot hide 15–25 kW on a hut or domestic meter; new service line + security deposit	Back-billing, disconnection
IRC / Kerala setbacks	IRC:46 10 m from carriageway; Kerala files often want ~50 m from road / footpath	PWD / NHAI hazard notice
NH RoW exclusion	No commercial hoarding inside National Highway right of way — private title is not enough if the pole sits in RoW	Removal; you eat the pole
Monsoon civil window	Do not open foundations after 1 June; a half-built unipole is a High Court case	Flooded pits, slipped calendar, rusted steel
AAI NOCAS	12–15 m tip is more likely to enter CIAL surfaces than a façade flush with the roof	Height cut after steel is up

Year-0 admin is why the unipole band is ₹6–10 L rather than ₹5–8 L: extra soil PE, KMBR as a new building, PWD / NHAI, and KSEB new-connection chasing. Critical path is typically **4–6 months**.

6. Cash to be live and monthly P&L

6.1 Money required before the first paid loop

	Building 18 sq.m	Building 32 sq.m	Unipole 1-face	Unipole dual
Screen + structure + electrics (cash, incl. IGST)	₹21 L	₹31 L	₹48 L	₹68 L
Admin, lawyers, engineers, filings, year-1 tax	₹5–8 L	₹5–8 L	₹6–10 L	₹6–10 L
Space deposit (3–6 months)	₹1.2–3.6 L	₹1.5–6.0 L	₹2.4–4.8 L	₹2.4–4.8 L
Cash to be live	**₹27–33 L**	**₹38–45 L**	**₹55–62 L**	**₹75–90 L**

Dual unipole top of band includes premium FOB (USD 650) or a long highway file. Volume OEM dual is closer to ₹77–83 L if admin stays inside ₹10 L.

6.2 Kochi Class A — building 32 sq.m, 10 slots × ₹50,000

	50% sold	75% sold	90% sold
Gross advertising revenue	₹2.50 L	₹3.75 L	₹4.50 L
Hybrid rent (max of ₹50,000 and 18%)	₹50,000	₹67,500	₹81,000
Power + tax + CMS + AMC (mid)	₹82,000	₹82,000	₹82,000
Left before sales commission and promoter salary	**₹1.18 L**	**₹2.26 L**	**₹2.87 L**

At 75% sold, simple payback on ₹41 L live cash (mid-range) is about **18 months** before commission.

6.3 Same loop on a unipole

	1-face 50%	1-face 75%	1-face 90%	Dual 75%	Dual 90%
Gross advertising revenue	₹2.50 L	₹3.75 L	₹4.50 L	₹7.50 L	₹9.00 L
Hybrid rent (max of ₹80,000 and 18%)	₹80,000	₹80,000	₹81,000	₹1.35 L	₹1.62 L
Power + tax + CMS + AMC (mid)	₹75,000	₹75,000	₹75,000	₹1.41 L	₹1.41 L
Left before commission and promoter salary	**₹0.95 L**	**₹2.20 L**	**₹2.94 L**	**₹4.74 L**	**₹5.97 L**

A single-face unipole at 75% sold leaves about the same monthly cash as the building (~₹2.2 L vs ₹2.26 L) because cheaper own-KSEB power offsets the higher ₹80,000 land floor. The penalty is capital: ~₹58 L live vs ~₹41 L, so payback stretches to about **26 months** before commission. Dual-face is why people build poles: at 75% sold the leftover is ~₹4.74 L/month; payback on ~₹80 L live cash is about **17 months** — close to the building, with twice the inventory — if both carriageways are actually sold.

Pre-sell at least half the loop before the crane. Programmatic (Hivestack / Lemma) is for unsold time, not the plan. Two Lulu/Forum kiosks at ₹8,500/slot still do not cover a small ops team. One Kochi outdoor face does, if the sightline is real.

7. SWOT — outdoor digital advertising (Kerala)

Scoped to a first Kochi outdoor LED, either **building-mounted** or a **private-land unipole outside NH RoW** — not mall MUPI, not a flex hoarding, not a pole inside highway land.

STRENGTHS

- Unit economics dwarf indoor: one 32 sq.m Kochi face at 75% sold leaves ~₹2.2–2.3 L/month after rent and power; a mall kiosk at ₹8,500 leaves ~₹0.3–0.4 L.
- Building mount cuts first-site hardware from ~₹48 L (volume unipole 1-face) or ~₹90 L (premium dual pole) to ~₹31 L.
- Unipole height and dual-face cover both carriageways from one plot; own KSEB avoids a 20% building power markup.
- National and regional brands already buy outdoor; jewellery, auto, education, healthcare and QSR are live categories in Kochi.
- Illegal flex removal and Corporation-designated LED create scarcity of *legal* digital inventory.
- Programmatic SSPs (Hivestack, Lemma) can fill remainder-of-loop without a second sales team.
- Hybrid rent shares downside with the building owner or landowner.

WEAKNESSES

- Permission is political and slow (30–90 days; 4–6 months if highway-facing or a new pole). Hardware can arrive before the file moves.
- KSEB is the second-largest site cost after rent (~₹48–60k / face / month).
- Unipole doubles (or triples) first-site capital vs a terrace; piles cannot be moved if the sightline was misread.
- Coastal monsoon: salt, 3,000 mm rain, 39 m/s design wind; cheap iron frames and acrylic conformal coat will fail. Do not open unipole foundations after 1 June.
- Older Kochi bye-law language favoured still creatives over film; video loops may be restricted until Town Planning confirms.
- Single-site concentration: one demolition order, slab refusal, or setback miss kills the only asset.
- Working capital: IGST at port, 3–6 months' deposit, and tax before permission, on top of OEM payment terms.
- Building path: you do not control power quality or terrace leakage. Unipole path: you own every pit, every rusted bolt, and the make-good of piles.

OPPORTUNITIES

- Kakkanad / InfoPark / Edappally catchments have advertisers who already spend on outdoor and digital.
- Corporation's own 50-board LED plan validates digital and can be a partner or a pricing umbrella — not only a rival — if you sit on private commercial land or buildings with clean files.
- October–November civil window is open now (southwest monsoon tail); anchors or foundations before next 1 June.
- Landlord / landowner JV (70/30) if cash is tight: you bring the screen, they bring the sightline.
- Bundle a later Lulu/Forum kiosk as "highway + mall" once the outdoor face is sold — do not lead with malls.
- Kozhikode Thondayad as site two after Kochi occupancy > 70%; less contested than NH 66 Kochi.
- Volume OEM / CKD at USD 330 / sq.m with a hard FAT keeps building-mount payback inside ~18 months; dual unipole can match that if both faces sell.

THREATS

- High Court and Corporation enforcement against unauthorised boards; private terrace or private plot is not a loophole without s. 272 leave.
- NHAI / MoRTH: no commercial hoarding in NH RoW; a façade or pole that reads NH 66 traffic can still be treated as a hazard. Kerala files often want ~50 m from the road, not only IRC's 10 m.
- Town Planning review of large digital boards (footpath, glare, motion) can tighten brightness and content rules after you have sold video.
- Structural / monsoon failure — public liability and criminal exposure; insurers will ask for the building certificate or the soil + PE pack.
- Customs reclass to 8528 59 00 (20% BCD) or container exam in rain voiding IP warranty.
- Landlord or landowner rent reset at renewal; association politics in mixed-use buildings; neighbour glare petitions on unipoles.
- Residential or domestic-meter sites: back-billing and disconnection.
- If you cannot pre-sell 50% of the loop, floor rent + power still run ~₹1.3 L/month (building) or ~₹1.55 L/month (unipole) on a dark board.

8. Decision and 90-day sequence

RECOMMENDATION

Prefer Path A: one road-facing 32 sq.m LED on a commercial Kochi building (Kakkanad / Edappally class) if a terrace or façade has a real sightline. Budget ₹38–45 lakh to be live. Use Path B (unipole) only if no such building exists, or you need both carriageways — then budget ₹55–62 lakh for one face or ₹75–90 lakh for dual. Still one Kochi site, not two poles, and not a mall cluster. File permission before paying the OEM in full. Pre-sell 50% occupancy. Add Kozhikode or a mall kiosk only after this face is above ~70% sold.

Week	Path A — building	Path B — unipole extra	Do not
1–2	Shortlist commercial buildings; written owner NOC; advocate on title	Private land outside NH RoW; IRC / ~50 m setback sketch; soil quote	Apartment terraces; domestic meters; plots in NH RoW
3–4	Structural engineer on the slab; hybrid licence; IBPMS + s. 272 file	Two boreholes; KMBR as a new structure; land hybrid at ₹80k or 18%	Order full FOB LED
5–8	Inspectorate drawings; sub-meter; tax challan; factory FAT / booking	New KSEB 15/25 kW file; PWD/NHAI pack; AAI NOCAS if the tip is high	Open foundations after 1 June; highway file with no PWD view
9–12	Permission in hand; cabinets ship; pre-sell 5–10 slots; night install; 72 h burn-in	Cast piles only after permission; crane + weld NDT; earth < 2 Ω	Go live dark; skip auto-dimming affidavit

If the only buildings on offer are shops glued to a service road or residential roofs, **do not spend the ₹31 lakh** on a terrace. If the only land on offer sits inside NH RoW or fails setback, **do not spend the ₹48–68 lakh** on a pole. The sightline is the asset; the screen is a commodity.

Planning rates as of September 2026. Sources used in the parent blueprint: Kerala Municipality Act ss. 271–272; KMBR 2019; KSERC LT-VII(A) Gazette 05-Dec-2024; Kerala Electricity Duty Act 1963 (10%); IS 875 Part 3 Vb 39 m/s; IRC:46-1972; CBIC heading 8528. Confirm with Kochi / Kozhikode / Kannur Corporation Revenue, a Kerala-enrolled advocate, and CBIC before committing capital. Regenerated with `python3 scripts/build_cost_swot_pdf.py`.